

Ooops!

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Over the years, Maria's café has become a whole world filled with gifts, but the sad time has now arrived for the place to close. When the very first object ever given to the café shatters, a new customer starts putting the pieces back together. As the pieces come back together, the café's beautiful history unfolds, but it also brings us progressively closer to its end.



User Journey 1/3

The experience spans two scenes: outside and inside the café. Through clicking and drag-and-drop interactions, the user repairs a broken object piece by piece, uncovering the café's story and the special connection between Maria and her customers.

01 Arrival

The experience begins outside the café on a cold, rainy day. The environment feels quiet and monotonous. Clicking on the café door starts the journey.



02 Inside

The user enters a warm, colorful space filled with memories and gifts. Maria welcomes them through a short audio introduction.

User Journey 2/3

03 Coffee Break

Clicking the coffee cup to take a sip unexpectedly causes the yellow amphora to shatter.



05 First Repair

Using drag-and-drop interactions, the user places the first shard back onto the transparent amphora. Each piece repaired moves the story forward in time, and objects begin to reappear.



04 Time Travel

The breaking sends the user back to the year the café first opened, with empty shelves.



06 Objects

Clicking a flashing object reveals its story and connection to Maria and her customers as an audio narrations (~30 seconds) with subtitles.



User Journey 3/3

07 Objects

Other objects reveal short written stories.



09 Restored

Once the amphora is fully repaired, the user returns to the present-day café. Clicking twice the receipt ends the experience.



08 Closing Hints

As more shards are repaired, clues appear. The user gradually discovers that the café is approaching its final days.



10 Goodbye

Outside again, where it all began, but with a deeper sense of what this place meant.

Final Production

If selected for exhibition, the project would be further developed in the following areas:

Object Stories

Refining and shortening existing stories, with the possibility of adding or exchanging some.
All objects on the shelves become fully interactive, each unlocking an audio narration or short text description.

Translation

Full French translation including new audio recordings, subtitles, and object descriptions.
Ideally, narrations would be re-recorded with trained voice actors to bring the stories fully to life.

3D & Interaction

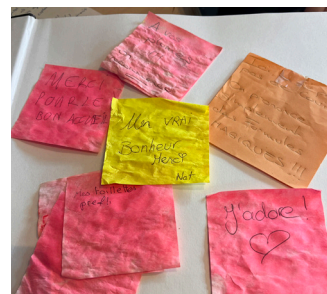
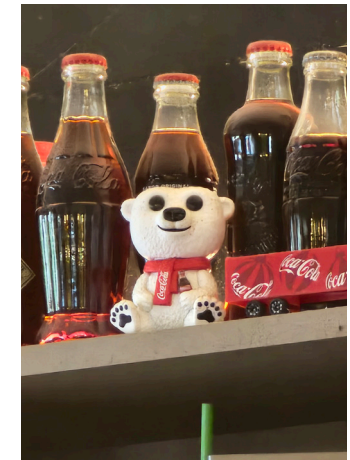
Refining the 3D environment and improving interactions, for example, larger shards of the yellow amphora for easier drag and drop.

Integrate the title of the project on the coffee as foam at the time the coffee is being drunk.



Field Research

We chose to visit the café “Le Jardin de Sonia.” The first time we went there, we simply explored the space to become familiar with the environment while having a coffee. We were surprised by the huge number of objects in the café, so we took many photos as we observed the space. We discussed and created theories about what each object might mean, including the purpose of the reserved Post-it notes and why they were there. We were warmly surprised by the small notes hidden inside a book and by the large number of messages written in the bathroom. During our second visit, when we conducted an interview, we finally learned the stories and meanings behind many of the things we had noticed during our first visit.



Main Inspiration

Name: Café le jardin de Sonia

Established: 2018 (takeover of existing café)

Status: Closing September 2026 (due to legal dispute)

UN VRAI BAR/CAFÉ DE QUARTIER !!

Accueille chaleureux, sourire toujours présent de la part de l'équipe. **Merci d'être là pour nous** 🍷



C'est un lieu sympa pour rencontrer dans un quartier qui manque d'une place et d'un centre.

Un endroit magique et hors du temps!

Tout le monde est bienvenu autant les adultes que les enfants ou encore les chiens . Je conseille vivement !

Two main inspirations shaped the project.

The first is the owner, Sonia, and her strong relationship with customers. She remembers their names and the drinks they order every day. She also tries to comfort customers when she notices they are struggling in life. During the interview, she said that she is like a therapist for some of her customers.

The second inspiration is Kintsukuroi - the Japanese art of repairing broken objects with gold and giving them a new life, which is reflected in one of the interactions shown in the final prototype.



kintsukuroi

(n.) (v. phr.) "to repair with gold"; the art of repairing pottery with gold or silver lacquer and understanding that the piece is more beautiful for having been broken

Art Direction

Our art direction is inspired by warm aesthetics and hand-drawn design styles. It focuses on key concepts such as coziness, comfort, and tranquility. We use warm colors to create a welcoming atmosphere that reflects the spirit of the café. The typography combines a more expressive, hand-drawn typeface for titles with a simpler, more readable font for object descriptions and smaller text elements.



LOGO

COMICO - TITLE

Nunito - Descriptions

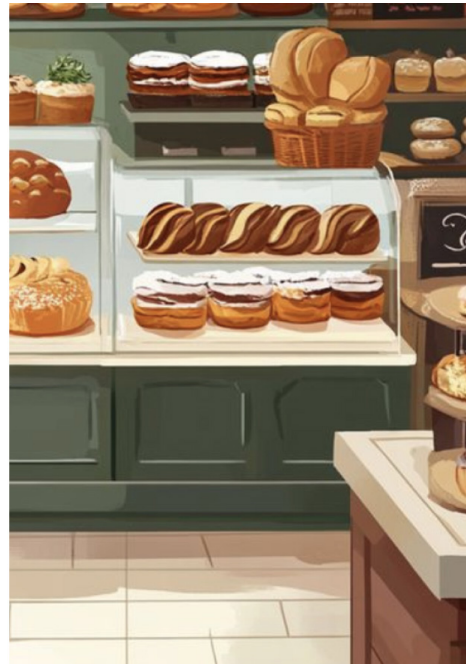


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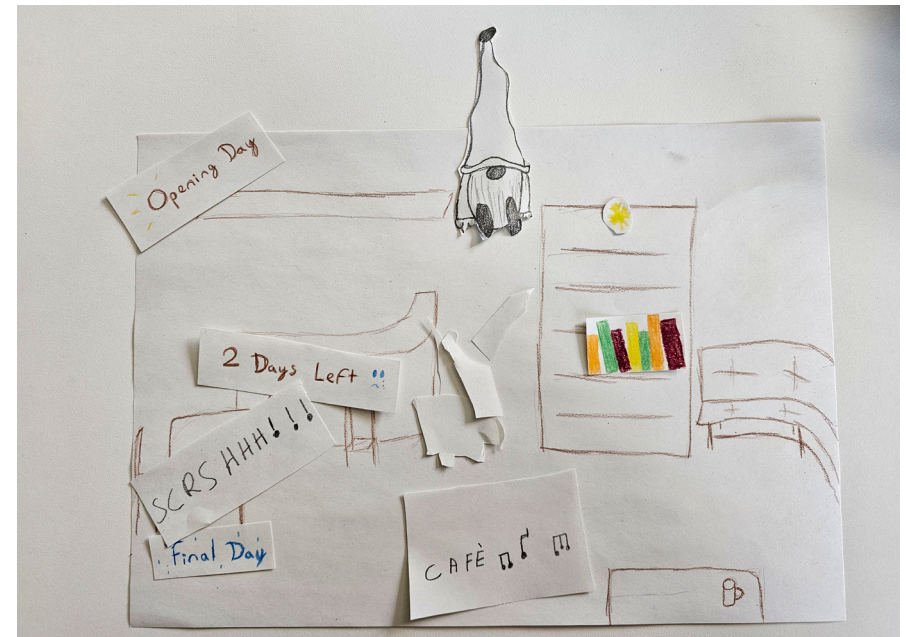
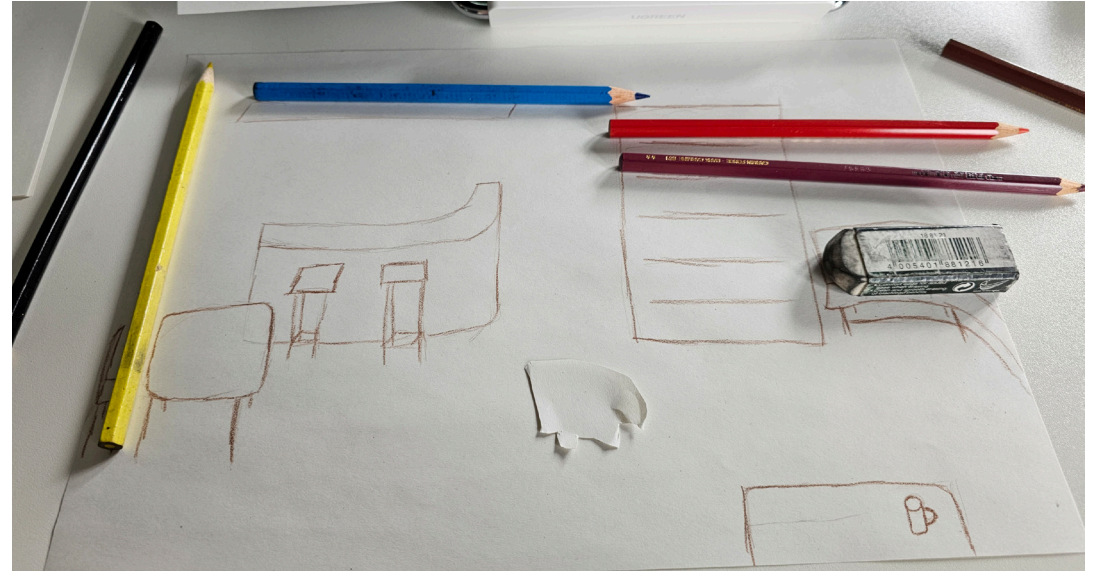
COLOUR PALETTE

Art Direction



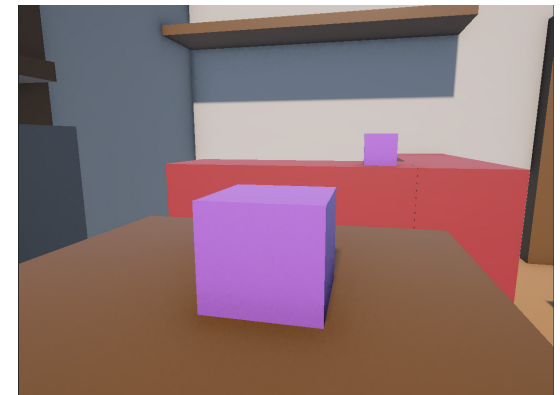
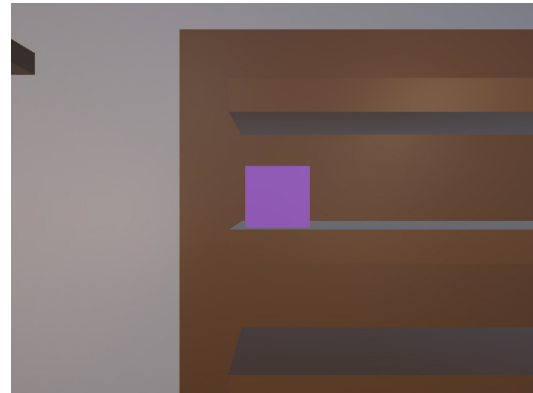
Cardboard Prototype

In the cardboard prototype, we sketched a preliminary layout of the café and placed cut-out objects on the shelves. One object was broken into shards because we had already decided that the main interaction would involve repairing it, while the other objects were only clickable. Simple squares represented different time frames, as placing a shard back into the object would advance the story through time. At this stage, we had not yet developed how clue objects would hint the closure during the experience, and how to showcase the advancement through different time periods.



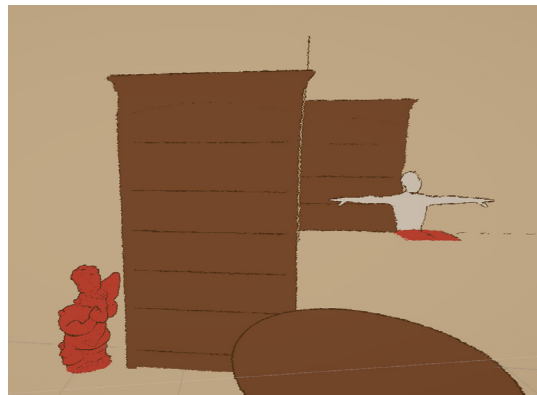
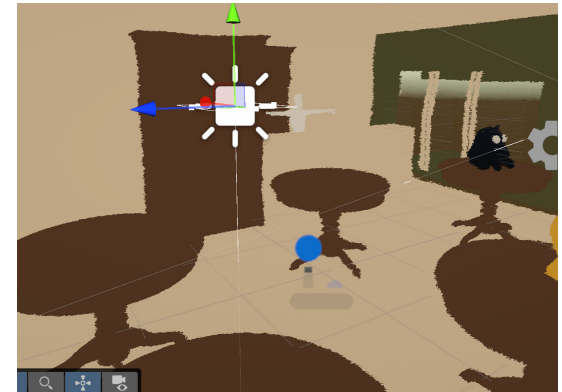
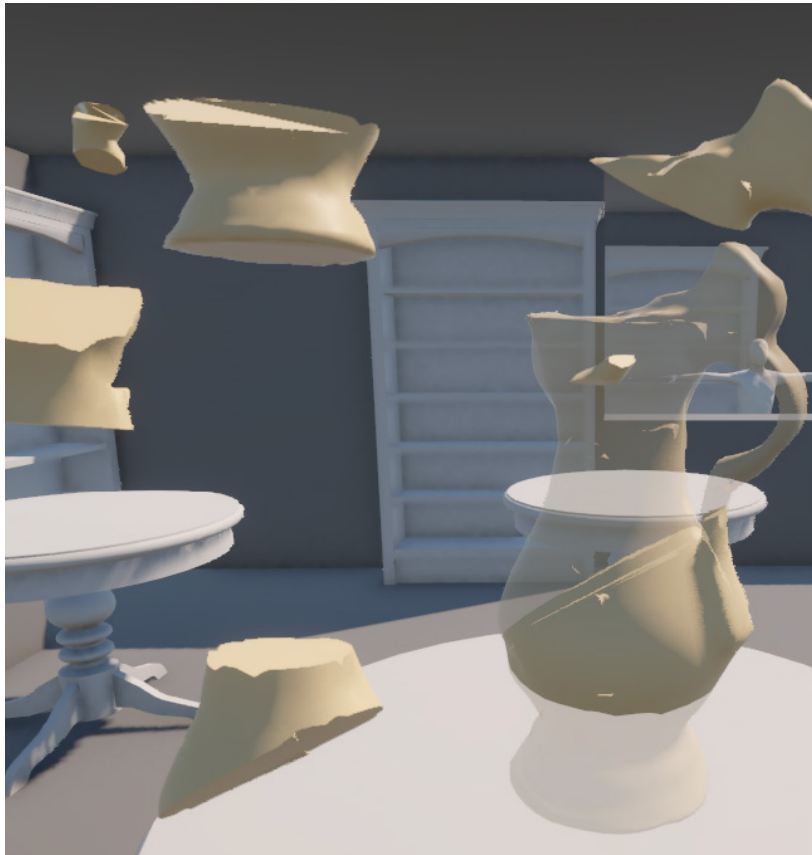
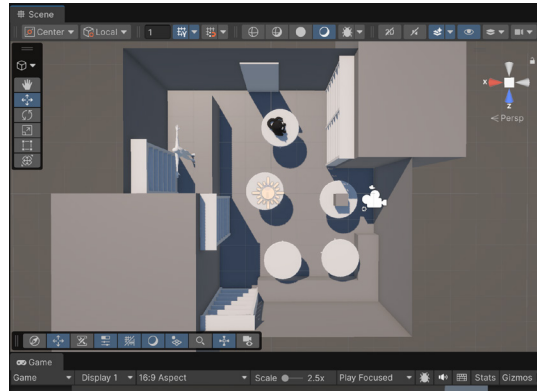
Greybox Prototype

Two different café layouts were explored: one more cubic and compact, and another larger with a more organic structure. The designs used simple geometric shapes such as cubes, rectangles, and cylinders, while also experimenting with basic interactions including object snapping, zooming into objects, and object breaking.



Greybox Prototype 2

Final greybox prototype with real objects, a defined café layout, and the beginning of interior shaping, along with evolving interactions. This version of the greybox also features early iterations of shaders and shadows.



User Tests

User tests were conducted throughout the development process, including during the greybox prototype stage. At this stage, testers initially tried clicking on the shards before realizing they needed to drag them. While zooming into objects was intuitive, returning to the initial position was less clear. Participants were also more attracted to the coffee cup interaction than to breaking the object by clicking on it.

